

Sick leave reform 2026 - summary of the new rules

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This summary covers the 2026 reform of incapacity for work for employees in the private sector.

Guaranteed salary

The employer keeps paying the guaranteed salary during the first month of incapacity. This rule is unchanged.

Return to work

The mutual insurance fund contacts the employee within 6 weeks of the start of incapacity to assess the possibilities for return to work.

Employer contribution

The reform introduces an employer contribution during months two and three of incapacity, from 1 July 2026. The rate and the exemption for small employers are set by royal decree; see the procedures library for the rate that payroll applies.

Example

An employee falls ill on 2 July 2026. Guaranteed salary until 1 August, sickness benefit from the mutual fund after that, employer contribution for August and September.

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